You can call this task on the server during deployment to create compiled versions of your assets directly on the server. See the next section for information on compiling locally.

The rake task is:

```
$ RAILS_ENV=production bin/rake assets:precompile
```

Capistrano (v2.15.1 and above) includes a recipe to handle this in deployment. Add the following line to `Capfile`:

```
load 'deploy/assets'
```

This links the folder specified in `config.assets.prefix` to `shared/assets`. If you already use this shared folder you'll need to write your own deployment task.

It is important that this folder is shared between deployments so that remotely cached pages referencing the old compiled assets still work for the life of the cached page.

The default matcher for compiling files includes `application.js`, `application.css` and all non-JS/CSS files (this will include all image assets automatically) from `app/assets` folders including your gems:

```
[ Proc.new { |filename, path| path =~ /app\/assets/ && !%w(.js
.css).include?(File.extname(filename)) },
/application.(css|js)$/ ]
```

The matcher (and other members of the precompile array; see below) is applied to final compiled file names. This means anything that compiles to JS/CSS is excluded, as well as raw JS/CSS files; for example, `.coffee` and `.scss` files are **not** automatically included as they compile to JS/CSS.

If you have other manifests or individual stylesheets and JavaScript files to include, you can add them to the `precompile` array in `config/initializers/assets.rb`:

```
Rails.application.config.assets.precompile += ['admin.js',
'admin.css', 'swfObject.js']
```

Always specify an expected compiled filename that ends with .js or .css, even if you want to add Sass or CoffeeScript files to the precompile array.

The rake task also generates a `manifest-md5hash.json` that contains a list with all your assets and their respective fingerprints. This is used by the Rails helper methods to avoid handing the mapping requests back to Sprockets. A typical manifest file looks like:

```
{"files":{"application-
723d1be6cc741a3aabb1cec24276d681.js":{"logical_path":"application.js","mtime":"201
3-07-26T22:55:03-07:00","size":302506,
"digest":"723d1be6cc741a3aabb1cec24276d681"},"application-
12b3c7dd74d2e9df37e7cbb1efa76a6d.css":{"logical_path":"application.css","mtime":"2
013-07-26T22:54:54-07:00","size":1560,
"digest":"12b3c7dd74d2e9df37e7cbb1efa76a6d"},"application-
1c5752789588ac18d7e1a50b1f0fd4c2.css":{"logical_path":"application.css","mtime":"2
013-07-26T22:56:17-07:00","size":1591,
"digest":"1c5752789588ac18d7e1a50b1f0fd4c2"},"favicon-
a9c641bf2b81f0476e876f7c5e375969.ico":{"logical_path":"favicon.ico","mtime":"2013-
07-26T23:00:10-07:00","size":1406,
"digest":"a9c641bf2b81f0476e876f7c5e375969"},"my_image-
231a680f23887d9dd70710ea5efd3c62.png":{"logical_path":"my_image.png","mtime":"2013
-07-26T23:00:27-07:00","size":6646,
"digest":"231a680f23887d9dd70710ea5efd3c62"}},"assets":{"application.js":
"application-723d1be6cc741a3aabb1cec24276d681.js","application.css":
"application-1c5752789588ac18d7e1a50b1f0fd4c2.css",
"favicon.ico":"favicona9c641bf2b81f0476e876f7c5e375969.ico","my_image.png":
"my_image-231a680f23887d9dd70710ea5efd3c62.png"}}
```

The default location for the manifest is the root of the location specified in `config.assets.prefix`('/assets' by default).